Saturday, May 13

Hard to understand whether the shooting has stopped or not. It seems that the US is sending signals that it is time to put an end to the game.

A few days ago I spoke to somebody who, like me, has not lived in Israel for quite some time, but who visits once or twice a year and shares my ideas about politics in the country. He confirmed what I sensed: the official politics were unpalatable, but on the other hand, the demonstrators are kindred souls, at least some of them, and, mainly, there are the friends, those friends whom one knew sometimes from grade or middle school and, more often, from the army, companions that sometimes accompany you for your entire life. In that sense the role of the army in Israel is quite unique. Notwithstanding its brutal behavior in the Occupied Territories, together with its function as a melting pot which it generally fulfills, it very often creates strong bonds and lifelong friendships. I did not share this experience, as I left immediately after my military service for studies in Paris, and it was there that I made a friend for many years. My case was not typical, but that of the person I talked to recently, is. What is sure is that one cannot stay indifferent to what happens in the country.

A truce with Islamic Jihad has taken effect.

Monday, May 15

According to Simcha Rotman, if the negotiations at the President's Residence—which are resuming tomorrow—fail, part of the judicial reform could be voted during the present Knesset session, that is, before July 30.

Netanyahu, who attributes to himself the success of the latest operation against Islamic Jihad, thanks the chief of staff and the army, but systematically avoids mentioning Gallant, the defense minister. The Likud has slightly benefited in the polls and the coalition today would get fifty-four votes.